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CSM Account Handover Checklist

An Urgency-Ordered Checklist So Context Never Gets Lost

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CSM Account Handover Checklist

A Structured Framework for Seamless Customer Transitions Without Losing Context, Trust, or Momentum

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Introduction

"Customers don't care that a Customer Success Manager has changed. They care that their experience doesn't."

One of the most overlooked moments in the customer lifecycle is the transition from one Customer Success Manager to another.

Organizations invest months building trust with customers.

A single poorly managed handover can undo much of that work in just a few weeks.

When account transitions are rushed or incomplete, important context disappears.

Business objectives become unclear.

Stakeholder relationships weaken.

Action items are forgotten.

Executive commitments are missed.

Quarterly Business Reviews are delayed.

Renewals become more difficult.

Customer confidence begins to decline.

The problem is rarely the new Customer Success Manager.

The problem is the absence of a structured handover process.

An effective handover ensures that customer knowledge remains with the organization rather than with an individual employee.

The incoming Customer Success Manager should understand far more than customer history.

They should understand:

- Why the customer originally purchased.
- The business outcomes the customer is trying to achieve.
- Executive priorities.

- Political dynamics within the organization.
- Stakeholder relationships.
- Product adoption.
- Customer Health Score.
- Current risks.
- Renewal strategy.
- Expansion opportunities.

Only then can the transition feel seamless from the customer's perspective.

This guide provides a practical framework for transferring customer ownership while maintaining momentum, protecting customer relationships, and reducing operational risk.

Throughout this document, you'll learn how to prepare accounts before a transition, communicate effectively with customers, align internal teams, prioritize critical information, and ensure that no important context is lost during the handover.

A successful handover is not measured by how quickly ownership changes.

It is measured by how little the customer notices that it happened.

Chapter 2

Why Customer Handover Matters

Every customer relationship is built on trust.

Over weeks, months, and sometimes years, Customer Success Managers learn how a customer thinks, how they make decisions, what success looks like to them, who influences executive decisions, and where potential risks exist.

When that knowledge stays only with one person, the organization becomes vulnerable.

A Customer Success Manager resigns.

Someone is promoted.

Accounts are redistributed.

A territory changes.

Without a structured handover, valuable customer knowledge disappears.

The incoming CSM starts asking questions the customer has already answered several times.

Meetings become repetitive.

Action items are missed.

Business priorities become unclear.

Customers begin wondering whether anyone truly understands their business.

A poor handover doesn't just create operational problems---it damages confidence.

Customers expect continuity.

They should never feel like they are starting the relationship from the beginning because someone internally changed roles.

A strong handover protects three things:

- Customer trust.
- Business momentum.
- Revenue.

Organizations that invest in structured handovers consistently experience higher renewal rates, stronger executive relationships, faster onboarding for new Customer Success Managers, and fewer customer escalations.

Customer knowledge should belong to the organization---not to an individual employee.

Chapter 3

When a Customer Handover Should Happen

Many organizations only think about handovers when a Customer Success Manager resigns.

In reality, customer transitions happen far more often.

Understanding when a structured handover is required prevents important information from being lost.

Common situations include:

Employee Resignation

The most common scenario.

Before the outgoing CSM leaves, every active account should have:

- Updated Customer Success Plans.
- Current Health Scores.
- Recent meeting notes.

- Stakeholder Maps.
- Open risks documented.
- Renewal status recorded.
- Expansion opportunities documented.

Nothing should rely on verbal explanations alone.

Internal Promotion

When a Customer Success Manager moves into leadership, strategic accounts are often reassigned.

A structured handover ensures those relationships continue without disruption.

Territory Realignment

As companies grow, customer portfolios are frequently redistributed across regions or market segments.

Although ownership changes internally, customers should experience uninterrupted support.

Maternity, Paternity, or Extended Leave

Temporary ownership changes require the same level of preparation as permanent transitions.

Customers should know:

Who their temporary contact is.

How long the transition will last.

How ongoing initiatives will continue.

Account Segmentation Changes

As customers grow, they may move from:

SMB → Mid-Market

Mid-Market → Enterprise

Digital Success → Dedicated Customer Success

Each transition requires complete knowledge transfer.

Customer Request

Occasionally, customers request a different Customer Success Manager.

Regardless of the reason, professionalism is essential.

The objective is to maintain customer confidence while ensuring the incoming CSM receives complete account context.

Chapter 4

Principles of an Effective Handover

Successful handovers are built on a few simple principles.

These principles ensure the transition feels almost invisible to the customer.

Principle 1 --- Customer Continuity Comes First

The customer should experience continuity---not disruption.

Meetings should continue.

Projects should continue.

Communication should continue.

Business outcomes should continue.

The transition should never interrupt customer progress.

Principle 2 --- Document Everything

Never assume information can be remembered later.

Document:

Business objectives.

Stakeholder relationships.

Executive priorities.

Customer preferences.

Meeting cadence.

Open action items.

Support history.

Renewal strategy.

Expansion discussions.

Health Score.

Implementation progress.

If it matters, write it down.

Principle 3 --- Transfer Business Context, Not Just Data

Simply sharing CRM records is not enough.

The incoming CSM needs context.

Examples include:

Why executives purchased the solution.

What internal political challenges exist.

Who influences decisions behind the scenes.

Which stakeholder is the strongest champion.

Which department has resisted adoption.

What conversations should never be repeated.

Context helps the new CSM make better decisions immediately.

Principle 4 --- Introduce the New CSM Properly

Whenever possible, customers should meet both the outgoing and incoming Customer Success Managers together.

This demonstrates continuity.

It also reassures the customer that knowledge has already been transferred.

A warm introduction creates confidence from the very beginning.

Principle 5 --- The Handover Ends Only After Stability

Ownership may transfer on Day One.

A successful handover is only complete when:

The customer has met the new CSM.

Outstanding actions continue without interruption.

Executive relationships remain strong.

No important commitments have been missed.

The customer feels supported.

Only then has the transition truly succeeded.

Chapter 5

The Customer Handover Framework

A structured handover follows four phases rather than a single meeting.

Each phase has a clear objective.

Phase 1 --- Preparation

The outgoing Customer Success Manager prepares the account.

Activities include:

Updating CRM.

Reviewing Customer Success Plans.

Documenting risks.

Updating Stakeholder Maps.

Reviewing Health Scores.

Summarizing recent meetings.

Recording renewal status.

Documenting expansion opportunities.

Preparing executive notes.

Phase 2 --- Knowledge Transfer

The outgoing and incoming Customer Success Managers meet internally.

Topics include:

Customer history.

Business objectives.

Current initiatives.

Political dynamics.

Executive relationships.

Customer personality.

Open commitments.

Potential risks.

Success factors.

Lessons learned.

Phase 3 --- Customer Introduction

Both Customer Success Managers meet with the customer.

Objectives include:

Introducing the incoming CSM.

Reinforcing continuity.

Reviewing ongoing priorities.

Confirming next milestones.

Answering customer questions.

Reassuring executive stakeholders.

Phase 4 --- Transition Monitoring

For the following one to two weeks, the incoming CSM closely monitors the account.

Activities include:

Reviewing action items.

Scheduling follow-up meetings.

Confirming stakeholder engagement.

Monitoring Customer Health.

Verifying milestone progress.

Ensuring no commitments have been missed.

The transition is considered complete only after the customer experiences uninterrupted continuity throughout the relationship.

Chapter 6

Immediate Actions (Day 1)

The first twenty-four hours after a customer handover are the most critical.

This is when the incoming Customer Success Manager builds momentum, verifies account information, and reassures the customer that nothing will fall through the cracks.

The objective is not to immediately change how the account is managed.

The objective is to understand it first.

Action 1 --- Review the Entire Customer History

Before contacting the customer, review every major customer document.

This includes:

- Customer Success Plan.
- Stakeholder Map.
- Customer Health Score.
- Implementation Plan.
- Executive Business Reviews.
- Meeting notes.
- Support history.
- Renewal timeline.
- Expansion opportunities.
- Open action items.

You should understand the customer's journey before introducing yourself.

Action 2 --- Meet With the Outgoing Customer Success Manager

If possible, schedule a detailed internal handover meeting.

Discuss topics that are rarely documented, including:

Executive personalities.

Communication preferences.

Internal politics.

Decision-making processes.

Previous challenges.

Customer expectations.

Relationship history.

These insights often determine the success of future conversations.

Action 3 --- Verify Open Commitments

Customers should never need to remind you about promises already made.

Review every outstanding commitment, including:

Pending support cases.

Implementation milestones.

Training sessions.

Product requests.

Executive follow-ups.

Quarterly Business Reviews.

Renewal activities.

Expansion discussions.

Create a prioritized action list before contacting the customer.

Action 4 --- Review Customer Health

Review the latest Customer Health Score.

Understand:

Current health status.

Recent changes.

Risk factors.

Positive trends.

Support history.

Adoption trends.

Executive engagement.

This provides a clear picture of where the relationship currently stands.

Action 5 --- Introduce Yourself

Reach out to the customer within the first day whenever possible.

The message should:

Introduce yourself.

Acknowledge the transition.

Reassure the customer that the account has already been reviewed.

Reinforce continuity.

Schedule an introductory meeting.

Customers should feel confident---not concerned---about the change.

Chapter 7

High Priority Actions (Days 1--2)

Once the initial transition has been completed, the next priority is developing a deeper understanding of the customer's current business situation.

The first two days should focus on validating information rather than making assumptions.

Review Current Business Objectives

Confirm that the Customer Success Plan is still aligned with the customer's priorities.

Business goals often change.

Recent acquisitions.

Leadership changes.

Budget adjustments.

Market conditions.

Strategic initiatives.

Any of these can alter what success looks like.

Validate Stakeholder Relationships

Review the Stakeholder Map.

Identify:

Executive sponsors.

Champions.

Decision-makers.

Technical contacts.

Operational users.

Potential blockers.

Relationship gaps.

If important stakeholders are missing, create a plan to engage them.

Review Product Adoption

Analyze current product usage.

Look for:

Declining logins.

Inactive teams.

Low feature adoption.

Training gaps.

License utilization.

These indicators often reveal hidden risks before customers mention them.

Meet Internal Teams

Speak with colleagues who have recently interacted with the customer.

Examples include:

Sales.

Implementation.

Professional Services.

Technical Support.

Product Management.

Finance.

Each team often holds valuable customer insights not captured in CRM records.

Build a Ninety-Day Success Plan

Before making any significant changes, create a transition plan.

Include:

Relationship-building activities.

Executive meetings.

Quarterly Business Reviews.

Risk mitigation.

Customer Health reviews.

Success Plan updates.

Renewal preparation.

This provides structure during the transition period.

Chapter 8

Standard Priority Actions (Days 3--5)

By the third day, the incoming Customer Success Manager should begin actively managing the account rather than simply learning about it.

The objective shifts from knowledge transfer to relationship building.

Conduct an Introduction Meeting

Hold a formal meeting with the customer.

The discussion should focus on:

Current priorities.

Business goals.

Recent progress.

Upcoming milestones.

Open challenges.

Future objectives.

Spend more time listening than presenting.

Confirm Success Plan Alignment

Review the Customer Success Plan together.

Ask questions such as:

"Have any priorities changed?"

"Are these still the right success metrics?"

"Is anything missing?"

The Success Plan should evolve alongside the customer's business.

Verify Executive Alignment

Determine whether executive sponsors remain engaged.

If executive participation has declined, schedule leadership check-ins before renewal planning begins.

Strong executive relationships reduce long-term customer risk.

Review Customer Health Together

Where appropriate, discuss:

Business outcomes achieved.

Adoption progress.

Upcoming milestones.

Current risks.

Future opportunities.

Transparency builds trust.

Update Internal Documentation

Following customer conversations, update:

CRM records.

Meeting notes.

Customer Success Plan.

Stakeholder Map.

Risk Register.

Health Score.

Renewal readiness.

Expansion opportunities.

Accurate documentation protects future handovers as well.

Chapter 9

Ongoing Transition Activities (Week 2)

By the second week, the customer should begin seeing the incoming Customer Success Manager as their primary strategic partner.

The transition should now focus on strengthening relationships rather than explaining the ownership change.

Deepen Executive Relationships

Schedule introductory conversations with executive stakeholders who were not involved in the initial transition.

Focus discussions on:

Strategic priorities.

Business outcomes.

Long-term objectives.

Future initiatives.

Avoid repeating information the customer has already shared.

Instead, build upon previous conversations.

Monitor Customer Health Closely

During the first few weeks, review Customer Health more frequently than normal.

Watch for:

Reduced engagement.

Delayed responses.

Support escalations.

Missed milestones.

Declining adoption.

Small changes often reveal whether the transition is affecting customer confidence.

Continue Existing Meeting Cadence

Avoid cancelling or delaying scheduled meetings simply because ownership has changed.

Consistency reinforces confidence.

Customers should experience the same level of engagement throughout the transition.

Validate Outstanding Action Items

Confirm that every commitment made before the handover is progressing as expected.

Nothing damages confidence faster than forgotten promises.

Evaluate Transition Success

Ask yourself:

Has the customer accepted the transition?

Are executives engaged?

Is the Success Plan still current?

Are risks under control?

Has customer confidence remained strong?

If the answer to these questions is yes, the handover has successfully moved from transition to long-term account management.

Chapter 10

Customer Communication During Handover

Customers should never discover that their Customer Success Manager has changed by receiving an email from someone they have never met.

Communication during a handover should build confidence, reduce uncertainty, and reinforce continuity.

The transition should feel intentional, well-planned, and customer-focused.

The message should never be:

"Your previous CSM has left. I'll be handling your account now."

Instead, it should communicate:

"Your partnership remains a priority, and we've carefully planned this transition to ensure your goals continue moving forward without interruption."

Communicate Early

Whenever possible, inform the customer before the transition officially happens.

This gives them time to ask questions and removes unnecessary surprises.

The announcement should include:

- The reason for the transition (where appropriate).
- The introduction of the incoming Customer Success Manager.
- Assurance that all account history has been transferred.
- Confirmation that current projects remain on track.
- Details of the upcoming introduction meeting.

Transparency builds trust.

Conduct a Joint Introduction

Whenever possible, the outgoing and incoming Customer Success Managers should meet the customer together.

This meeting allows the outgoing CSM to:

- Introduce the incoming CSM.
- Reinforce confidence in the transition.
- Review current priorities.
- Confirm outstanding commitments.
- Officially transfer ownership.

This simple step significantly reduces customer anxiety.

Focus on the Customer's Goals

The conversation should not revolve around internal staffing changes.

Instead, it should focus on:

Business objectives.

Current priorities.

Upcoming milestones.

Executive initiatives.

Success metrics.

The customer should leave the meeting feeling that nothing important has changed.

Follow Up Promptly

Within twenty-four hours after the introduction meeting, send a summary including:

Meeting highlights.

Agreed action items.

Owners.

Target dates.

Next meeting.

This demonstrates organization and accountability from the very beginning.

Chapter 11

Internal Team Alignment

A customer handover affects far more than Customer Success.

Several internal teams rely on accurate customer information to deliver a consistent experience.

Without internal alignment, customers often receive conflicting messages from different departments.

The incoming Customer Success Manager should coordinate with all customer-facing teams.

Sales

Review:

Commercial commitments.

Pricing discussions.

Expansion opportunities.

Contract terms.

Future opportunities.

Understanding the commercial relationship prevents conflicting conversations.

Professional Services

Review:

Implementation status.

Outstanding deliverables.

Training activities.

Project documentation.

Open dependencies.

This ensures implementation momentum continues uninterrupted.

Technical Support

Understand:

Open support tickets.

Recurring technical issues.

Escalated cases.

Customer satisfaction trends.

Support history often reveals issues that may not appear during customer meetings.

Product Team

Review:

Feature requests.

Enhancement discussions.

Beta participation.

Product roadmap conversations.

Customers appreciate knowing their feedback has been heard.

Finance

Confirm:

Billing status.

Outstanding invoices.

Renewal dates.

Purchase orders.

Procurement contacts.

Unexpected billing issues can damage otherwise healthy customer relationships.

Leadership

Where appropriate, brief Customer Success leadership on:

Strategic accounts.

High-risk customers.

Executive relationships.

Renewal forecasts.

Expansion opportunities.

Leadership visibility ensures additional support is available if needed.

Chapter 12

Common Handover Risks

Even experienced Customer Success organizations occasionally struggle with customer transitions.

Understanding common risks helps prevent avoidable mistakes.

Incomplete Documentation

One of the biggest risks is assuming CRM notes are sufficient.

Often, important business context exists only in the outgoing CSM's memory.

Examples include:

Executive preferences.

Political dynamics.

Hidden blockers.

Informal commitments.

Customer personalities.

These insights should always be documented before ownership changes.

Delayed Customer Communication

Customers should never wonder why their usual contact has stopped responding.

Delayed communication creates uncertainty and weakens confidence.

Inform customers early.

Lost Action Items

Projects frequently slow down because open commitments are forgotten during transition.

Examples include:

Training sessions.

Support follow-ups.

Executive meetings.

Product requests.

Implementation milestones.

Every outstanding commitment should be tracked before ownership changes.

Weak Executive Relationships

Sometimes only one executive knows the outgoing Customer Success Manager.

If that relationship disappears during transition, executive engagement may decline.

Diversifying stakeholder relationships throughout the customer lifecycle reduces this risk.

Assuming Everything Is Fine

A healthy Customer Health Score does not eliminate transition risk.

Even healthy customers require proactive communication and reassurance during ownership changes.

Never assume silence means satisfaction.

Poor Internal Communication

Customer Success, Sales, Support, Finance, and Product should all understand when ownership changes.

Customers should never have to explain internal transitions to different departments.

Internal alignment creates a seamless customer experience.

Chapter 13

Real World Case Studies

Case Study 1 --- FlyTrack Logistics

Following an internal promotion, FlyTrack Logistics assigned a new Customer Success Manager to one of its largest enterprise customers.

Instead of simply transferring CRM ownership, the outgoing CSM prepared a detailed handover package that included the Customer Success Plan, Stakeholder Map, Customer Health Score, Executive Business Reviews, renewal strategy, and implementation history.

A joint customer meeting was held before the transition became official.

The customer met the incoming CSM, reviewed ongoing priorities, and confirmed future milestones.

Because the transition was carefully planned, no projects were delayed, the Quarterly Business Review proceeded as scheduled, and the customer renewed later that year without disruption.

Case Study 2 --- LendWise

A regional financial institution using LendWise experienced a Customer Success ownership change during a major digital transformation project.

Several implementation milestones were still in progress, making the timing particularly sensitive.

Rather than rushing the transition, the outgoing and incoming Customer Success Managers spent two days reviewing documentation, support history, stakeholder relationships, and executive expectations.

During the first week, the new CSM conducted individual meetings with the Operations Director, IT Manager, and Executive Sponsor to reinforce continuity.

The implementation remained on schedule, customer confidence remained high, and leadership praised the professionalism of the transition.

Case Study 3 --- Nova Health Clinics

Nova Health Clinics underwent an internal restructuring that resulted in several healthcare facilities moving to a new regional Customer Success team.

Instead of assigning accounts immediately, the organization followed a structured handover process.

Every account included updated Success Plans, Health Scores, Stakeholder Maps, implementation notes, and current business objectives.

The incoming Customer Success Managers met with hospital administrators before assuming full ownership.

Because each facility received consistent communication and no commitments were missed, the transition was completed without affecting onboarding timelines or executive relationships.

The structured process protected both customer confidence and operational momentum.

Chapter 14

AI Workflow for Customer Handovers

A structured handover becomes significantly more efficient when Artificial Intelligence is used to organize information, summarize account history, identify risks, and prepare transition documentation.

AI should never replace the judgment of a Customer Success Manager.

Instead, it should eliminate repetitive administrative work so Customer Success Managers can focus on strengthening customer relationships.

Below is a practical workflow that can be incorporated into every account transition.

Step 1 --- Gather Customer Information

Before using AI, collect all available customer documentation.

This should include:

- Customer Success Plan.
- Stakeholder Map.
- Customer Health Score.
- Meeting notes.
- Executive Business Reviews.
- Product usage reports.
- Support history.
- Risk Register.
- Renewal timeline.
- Expansion opportunities.
- Customer feedback.
- Recent emails and action items.

The more complete the information, the more valuable the AI output becomes.

Step 2 --- Generate an Account Summary

Rather than reading months of meeting notes manually, AI can produce a concise account overview.

Example Prompt

Act as a Senior Customer Success Manager. Review the information below and create a two-page executive account summary that includes the customer's business objectives, current health, stakeholder relationships, implementation progress, business outcomes achieved, renewal status, expansion opportunities, open risks, and recommended next steps for the incoming Customer Success Manager.

The output should provide the incoming CSM with a complete understanding of the account before the first customer meeting.

Step 3 --- Analyze Customer Risks

AI can identify patterns that may not be immediately obvious.

Example Prompt

Review the customer's recent meeting notes, support history, product adoption trends, and Customer Health Score. Identify the top five risks that could affect customer success over the next ninety days. Explain why each risk matters and recommend actions to reduce it.

This allows the incoming Customer Success Manager to prioritize high-impact activities immediately after taking ownership.

Step 4 --- Prepare the Introduction Meeting

AI can help build a structured agenda for the first customer conversation.

Example Prompt

Using the customer information below, prepare a sixty-minute introduction meeting agenda that reinforces continuity, reviews business goals, confirms current priorities, validates stakeholder alignment, and ends with agreed next steps.

This ensures every transition meeting remains focused on customer outcomes rather than internal staffing changes.

Step 5 --- Generate the Follow-Up Summary

After the introduction meeting, AI can draft a professional summary.

The summary should include:

- Meeting overview.
- Decisions made.
- Action items.
- Owners.
- Target completion dates.
- Next meeting.
- Risks identified.

The Customer Success Manager should review and personalize the summary before sending it to the customer.

Step 6 --- Create a Thirty-Day Transition Plan

The first month after a handover is critical.

AI can organize the transition into clear priorities.

Example categories include:

Week 1:

Relationship building.

Week 2:

Executive introductions.

Week 3:

Customer Health validation.

Week 4:

Success Plan review.

Renewal preparation.

Expansion assessment.

This provides structure while ensuring no important activities are overlooked.

Chapter 15

Best Practices

Successful customer handovers are built on consistency rather than improvisation.

The following practices help ensure that every transition strengthens---not weakens---the customer relationship.

Start Preparing Before the Last Day

A handover should never begin on an employee's final day.

Documentation should be updated continuously so transitions can occur at any time with minimal disruption.

Keep Documentation Current

Customer Success Plans, Stakeholder Maps, Risk Registers, Health Scores, and meeting notes should always reflect the current state of the account.

Well-maintained documentation makes every future handover easier.

Introduce the Incoming CSM Early

Whenever possible, customers should meet the incoming Customer Success Manager before ownership officially changes.

A warm introduction builds trust and removes uncertainty.

Focus on Business Continuity

The transition should emphasize the customer's goals, ongoing initiatives, and expected outcomes---not internal organizational changes.

Customers care most about whether their objectives will continue to be achieved.

Confirm Every Outstanding Commitment

Review all promises made to the customer.

Examples include:

Training sessions.

Support escalations.

Feature requests.

Executive follow-ups.

Implementation milestones.

Quarterly Business Reviews.

Renewal activities.

Nothing should disappear during the transition.

Treat Every Handover as a Customer Risk

Even healthy accounts can become vulnerable during ownership changes.

Include handovers in Customer Risk Reviews until the transition has been fully completed.

Chapter 16

Complete Customer Handover Checklist Template

Account Information

Customer Name:

Industry:

Customer Success Manager (Outgoing):

Customer Success Manager (Incoming):

Transition Date:

Immediate (Day 1)

- ☐ Reviewed Customer Success Plan
- ☐ Reviewed Stakeholder Map
- ☐ Reviewed Customer Health Score
- ☐ Reviewed Implementation Progress
- ☐ Reviewed Meeting Notes
- ☐ Reviewed Support History
- ☐ Reviewed Renewal Timeline
- ☐ Reviewed Expansion Opportunities
- ☐ Met with Outgoing Customer Success Manager
- ☐ Created Initial Transition Plan

High Priority (Days 1--2)

- ☐ Validated Business Objectives
- ☐ Reviewed Product Adoption
- ☐ Confirmed Stakeholder Relationships
- ☐ Identified Open Risks
- ☐ Reviewed Executive Engagement
- ☐ Met Internal Teams
- ☐ Scheduled Customer Introduction Meeting

Standard Priority (Days 3--5)

- ☐ Conducted Customer Introduction Meeting
- ☐ Updated Customer Success Plan
- ☐ Updated Stakeholder Map
- ☐ Updated CRM Records
- ☐ Confirmed Outstanding Action Items

- ☐ Reviewed Customer Health
- ☐ Planned Next Executive Business Review

Ongoing (Week 2)

- ☐ Executive Introductions Completed
- ☐ Customer Health Reviewed
- ☐ Success Plan Validated
- ☐ Renewal Readiness Reviewed
- ☐ Expansion Opportunities Assessed
- ☐ Outstanding Risks Monitored
- ☐ Customer Feedback Collected
- ☐ Transition Successfully Completed

Chapter 17

Conclusion

A customer handover is much more than an administrative transfer of account ownership.

It is a critical moment that tests the strength of an organization's Customer Success process.

When customer knowledge is documented properly, stakeholders remain engaged, communication is proactive, and business objectives remain the central focus, transitions become almost invisible to the customer.

The strongest Customer Success organizations recognize that relationships belong to the company---not to individual employees.

By following a structured handover framework, maintaining accurate documentation, leveraging AI to reduce administrative effort, and treating every transition as a strategic business event, Customer Success teams can preserve trust, protect recurring revenue, and ensure customers continue progressing toward their desired outcomes without interruption.

An effective handover is not measured by how quickly an account changes hands.

It is measured by how confidently the customer continues moving forward.

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